Late discord delays Franco-German deal on Made in Europe, car emissions

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【要点】

・フランスとドイツは「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」ルールとCO2排出削減目標、2035年のガソリン車廃止に関する共通立場の合意に失敗した。ドイツの社会民主党が環境目標の低下を懸念して反対している。

・提案されている取引では、ドイツが自動車産業に対するより厳しい「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」基準を受け入れる代わりに、ガソリン車廃止規制を緩和することが想定されている。

・現在のEU目標は2035年までにガソリン車の排出ガスを2021年比で100%削減することだが、フランス・ドイツの提案では90%への緩和と代替燃料投資でさらに10%の猶予を求めている。

・グリーンスチール投資要件が廃止される見込みで、鉄鋼業界にとって主要市場が失われる懸念がある。

【メール原文】

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Late discord delays Franco-German deal on Made in Europe, car emissions
By Giorgio Leali, Jordyn Dahl, Tom Schmidtgen, Hans von der Burchard · Oct 15, 2026, 11:22 PM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — France and Germany on Thursday failed to agree a common position on the scope of the bloc's future "Made in Europe" rules, as well as on greater flexibility for CO2 emissions cuts and the 2035 combustion engine ban.

The draft quid-pro-quo deal, which was first reported by POLITICO in July , marks a major convergence between the two countries and had been expected to be signed imminently. On Thursday evening, however, the agreement stalled amid opposition from Germany's Social Democratic Party, the center-left junior partner in the ruling coalition, over concerns it dropped key environmental targets.

"A final agreement has yet to be reached," a German government spokesperson said.

Earlier this week, French President Emmanuel Macron had suggested the ball was in the German court. "There are political constraints on the other side of the Rhine, and I completely respect coalition discussions," Macron said Monday on the sidelines of the Paris car show.

Under the terms of the proposed deal, Germany would accept stricter Made in Europe criteria for the automotive sector in the Industrial Accelerator Act, which France has pushed for, in exchange for weakening the combustion engine ban, one of Berlin's long-term demands.

“In light of the significant technological, economic and geopolitical changes since the existing regulatory framework was established, the Automotive Package should strike a better balance between climate objectives, industrial competitiveness, technological development and the strengthening of European value creation,” the two countries wrote in a draft agreement obtained by POLITICO .

“Based on the Franco-German Ministerial Councils in 2025 and 2026, Germany and France therefore propose a balanced negotiating package combining ambitious CO_2 reduction targets with additional flexibility and targeted incentives for European value creation,” the agreement adds.

Currently, the EU’s target is for companies to reduce combustion engine emissions by 100% from 2021 levels by 2035, with the possibility to ‘earn’ 10% of emissions leeway through initiatives like offsets and investments.

Under the proposed deal, France and Germany want to soften the 2035 target to 90%, and to offer a further 10% leeway in exchange for investments in alternative fuels (for a combined 80%).

Crucially for steel manufacturers and Germany’s leftist SPD, the French-German agreement would axe the green steel investment requirement, removing a key incentive.

“This destroys the lead market for the steel industry,” an industry lobbyist told POLITICO on condition of anonymity to discuss the sensitive topic. In failing to put pressure on automakers to source green steel, the draft deal makes it a “nice-to-have” extra, they explained.

In a concession to Berlin, the draft agreement stresses that the so-called utility factor — which calculates plug-in hybrid emissions based on how often a vehicle’s electric motor is used vs. its combustion engine — should be calculated on lab-based results rather than real-world data, as required by the Commission. The change will help automakers sell more plug-in hybrids while still reaching the broader emissions targets.

In exchange for these emissions concessions, Germany endorsed France’s demand that the scope of the Made in Europe rules under the bloc’s Industrial Accelerator Act be restricted when it comes to the automotive sector.

The text only covers the EU’s 27 member countries and will be extended to the U.K. under certain conditions.

EU industry chief Stéphane Séjourné told POLITICO on Tuesday that he supported the deal as a way of breaking the impasse, and said the U.K. currently qualifies for Made in Europe.

The agreement could resolve a stalemate over both the CO2 regulation and the IAA, in which France and Germany have been on opposite sides. “The elements of this combined package should be adopted as soon as possible and at the same time,” the two countries wrote.

The British government welcomed the potential inclusion of the U.K. in the Made in Europe rules for cars.

“This is a Franco-German proposal and there is still a European process to run, but if confirmed, we welcome the objective to have the U.K. included in the Industrial Accelerator Act, and this would be good news for the British automotive industry and the jobs and investment it supports across the U.K.,” a No. 10 official said in a statement.

If approved, the comprehensive Franco-German deal will still have to be approved by other EU countries and by the European Parliament, which are currently discussing the Industrial Accelerator Act and the automotive package, including emissions targets for automakers.

Carlo Martuscelli, Francesca Micheletti and Graham Lanktree contributed to this report.

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